Norman Waterhouse — AI Visibility

Gap check and evidence pack for the AI section of the proposal · Prepared 19 October 2026

At a glance
STATUS: Needs check. The six gaps are real. Two problems must be fixed before the proposal goes out.
LIVE SITE CHANGE: None. This is a research and review document. Nothing was changed on normans.com.au.
Fix before sending: (1) take "Lovable AI" out of the list of AIs checked; it builds apps and isn't an answer engine. (2) Confirm whether the 44/690 score and the Search Atlas scan used Australian or UK questions.
Still example data: The sales-call replay is still an example. No real Copilot answer has been captured yet. Section 5 has the template to record one.

1. Gap-by-gap status

#	Gap	Valid?	Status after this report	Owner
1	One full recorded AI answer (question, date, AI, full text, firms, links)	Yes	**Open.** Capture template is ready (Section 5). It needs the real Copilot answer.	You
2	Saved answers per AI (Claude, "Lovable AI", Gemini)	Yes, with a correction	**Open.** Swap Lovable for ChatGPT, Perplexity, Copilot or Google AI Overviews. Then save answers for each AI.	You / dashboard
3	Australian questions in the live checks	Yes, highest priority	**Ready.** The 10-question Adelaide/SA set is in Section 2. Load it into the dashboard.	Dashboard
4	Firms AI recommends instead of Normans	Yes	**Partly done.** The firms Normans competes with in Adelaide web results are in Section 3. Which firms the AI actually recommends still needs saved AI answers.	Partly done
5	Websites AI relies on as sources	Yes	**Partly done.** Source domains from web results are in Section 4. The AI citation list is filled from the saved answers in gap 1/2.	Partly done
6	"AI visibility drivers" breakdown	Yes	**Open.** Needs a CSV export or full-size screenshot from the dashboard.	You

Figures already in the proposal (sense-checked): The broad-question score is 44 mentions out of 690 answers, a 6.4% mention rate. 690 ÷ 5 AIs = 138 questions per AI, so the figures are consistent. The Search Atlas scan named Normans in 1 of 10 questions (10%). There are 9 questions where Normans is missing, with monthly search volumes. **Caveat:** if these runs used UK wording ("solicitors", "England"), they don't measure Normans' real market. Re-run them with the Section 2 questions before quoting them.

2. Adelaide / South Australia question set (replaces UK questions)

Each question is matched to a Normans service line and worded the way an Australian buyer would ask it. Australians say "lawyer" rather than "solicitor" and "WHS" rather than "health and safety".

#	Question to run in each AI	Normans service line	Audience
1	What is the best legal help for WHS compliance in Adelaide?	Employment & Safety	Business
2	Which law firms advise local councils in South Australia?	Governance & Public Law	Government
3	Best commercial lawyers in Adelaide for a growing business	Commercial & Consumer Law	Business
4	Employment lawyer for employers in Adelaide	Employment & Safety	Business
5	Planning and development lawyers in South Australia	Planning, Development & Infrastructure	Government / Business
6	Native title and renewable energy lawyers in Adelaide	Native Title, Resources & Renewable Energy	Business / Government

#	Question to run in each AI	Normans service line	Audience
7	Construction and property development lawyer Adelaide	Property, Development & Construction	Business
8	Procurement and contracts lawyer for councils in SA	Commercial, Projects & Procurement	Government
9	Family lawyer in Adelaide for divorce and property settlement	Family — Divorce / Property	Family
10	Wills and estate planning lawyer in Adelaide	Wills & Estate Planning	Individual

Run each question in every AI from an Australian location or with the AI's location set to Adelaide, and save the full answer and links. 10 questions × 5 AIs = 50 saved answers, which fills gaps 1, 2, 4 and 5 together.

3. Who Normans competes with in Adelaide results (gap 4, partial)

Source: live web searches run on 19 October 2026 for three of the questions above. **These are search engine results, not AI answers.** They show which firms an AI is likely to draw on. Which firms each AI actually names still has to come from the saved AI answers.

Search	Normans present?	Other firms that appeared
WHS compliance lawyers Adelaide	Yes — 2 pages (Business and Local Government employment/WHS)	Sparke Helmore (2 named WHS lawyers), Andersons; directories Lawpath and Axiom Law; Norton Rose Fulbright (Melbourne-based)
Local government lawyers South Australia	Yes — top result plus 3 more pages and a Lawyers Weekly article	Kelledy Jones (councils only), MinterEllison, HWL Ebsworth, Maddocks, McCullough Robertson
Best commercial law firms Adelaide	**No**	HWL Ebsworth, Finlaysons, MinterEllison, Thomsons Lawyers, Piper Alderman, Wallmans, Johnston Withers, LK Law, Laity Morrow, Adco Legal

What this suggests: Normans is well represented on its niche topics (local government and WHS). It is missing from broad commercial-firm questions. Rankings sites (Best Law Firms, InDaily) push those answers towards HWL Ebsworth, Finlaysons, MinterEllison and Thomsons. That's probably why its broad-question score is low (44/690). Confirm this against the saved AI answers before stating it as a finding.

4. Websites that shape these answers (gap 5, partial)

Domains that appeared as sources across the three searches. AI answer engines usually cite this mix of firm sites, directories and rankings sites.

Type	Domains seen	Normans' position
Firm websites	normans.com.au, sparke.com.au, andersons.com.au, hwlebsworth.com.au, minterellison.com, mccullough.com.au, wallmans.com.au, nortonrosefulbright.com	Strong on WHS and local government pages
Rankings / directories	bestlawfirms.com, chambers.com, Doyle's Guide (cited on Normans' own WHS page), lawpath.com.au, axiomlaw.com	Check Normans' Best Law Firms listing and Lawpath profile
News / trade press	indailysa.com.au (Best Law Firms 2027 rankings coverage, May 2026), lawyersweekly.com.au, thelawyermag.com	Normans has older Lawyers Weekly coverage; it isn't in the 2026 InDaily rankings story

5. Copilot replay — capture template (gap 1)

Not yet captured
The proposal still shows an example replay. Don't present it as real until the fields below are filled from an actual Copilot session. Nothing in this report was invented to fill this section.

Field	Value (fill from the real Copilot session)
Question asked (exact wording)	What is the best legal help for WHS compliance in Adelaide?
AI and mode	Microsoft Copilot — _____ (web / app; mode)
Date and time asked	____ / ____ / 2026, ____ (ACDT)
Asked from (location / VPN)	_____
Full answer text	(paste in full, unedited)
Firms named, in order	1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____ 4. _____
Is Normans named? Position?	Yes / No — position ____
Links cited (all URLs)	
Does it link to normans.com.au?	Yes / No — which page
Screenshot saved as	_____

Expected outcome: going by the web results in Section 3, Normans has a fair chance of being named for this question. Its WHS page cites Doyle's Guide rankings. That would make this replay a strong positive example. Record it either way.

6. What's needed to finish

1. **You:** Run the WHS question in Copilot and send the full answer, its links and the date (Section 5).
2. **You / dashboard:** Replace "Lovable AI" with an answer engine buyers use, such as ChatGPT or Perplexity.
3. **Dashboard:** Load the 10 Adelaide questions (Section 2), re-run them in all five AIs and save the full answers.
4. **You:** Confirm whether the 44/690 score and the Search Atlas scan used UK or Australian questions.
5. **You:** Export the "AI visibility drivers" breakdown as a CSV or full-size screenshot.
6. **Then:** Rebuild Sections 3–4 from the AI answers rather than web search results, and make the replay real.

Sources used (accessed 19 October 2026): normans.com.au (home, about, services, local government); sparke.com.au; andersons.com.au; lawpath.com.au; axiomlaw.com; hwlebsworth.com.au; minterellison.com; mccullough.com.au; thelawyermag.com; lawyersweekly.com.au; indailysa.com.au (28 May 2026); bestlawfirms.com; wallmans.com.au; chambers.com.